



Connect Transcript

Hello everyone, welcome to Bitspil and Read Digital. Today we will continue our learning journey for the course Data Visualisation Storytelling. We will be now looking at a web-based business intelligence tool called Google Data Studio.

It is like Power BI or Tableau and used for creating dashboards and business reports. The main feature of Google Data Studio is it is a web-based tool, which means it works in a cloud-based environment and can easily connect with online data and create up-to-date dashboards, especially useful for the small businesses and e-commerce units. So let us now explore the various features in the Google Data Studio and try to build a small dashboard.

For this purpose, we are again using the EU sample store data, and this time we will be using it in a web-based environment. I have imported the data into Google Sheets already. We have the data, and then right now we also have the Google Studio environment.

To access this, what you have to do is go to Google, type Google Data Studio, and you will land up on something like this. So you can click on simply this particular part, and you should have a Google account to log in. Generally, you can also work without a Google account, but it is advisable that you can simply access this with a Google account, and then this is the interface that you will end up on.

So there are different ways to create the data reports. First and foremost is to understand the data sources and what are the different types of data sources out there. For example, you want to add a new report, so you want to add a new data source.

So you can create, starting which you can create with a blank report, and then there are also other templates. In fact, there is an entire template gallery which you can look into and try to see what are the different types of dashboards created by various parties. For example, I am looking at this Olympic TV ad performance.

It's a very simple dashboard. So it says Olympic TV ad performance, 2006 Olympics, NBC broadcast. So these are the different tools, different visualisations that are presented on the dashboard.

See, it is just like an A4 page arranged in the landscape mode, Google logo, with the TV ad performance. Okay, then there are six particular visualisations or seven particular visualisations here, each one conveying separate information and the look and feel of the report is very good. It's some narration and everything updated.

And you can use this for publishing and you can share this with your colleagues or also connect this with live data so that it gets updated on a regular basis, which you



can use later. What I'm trying to do is today to use our good old EU sample source data and try to create a simple dashboard report like this executive dashboard for monitoring sales so that you know the various features that are there and then try to compare them using different visualisations. So let us first start by understanding how do you get into the Google Data Studio environment and how to import data.

As I said, it is basically a web-based environment. You can look at the various data sources it will get connected to. So there are native data connectors which are managed by Google.

So there are so many data connectors like directly you can start with Looker, Google Analytics, Google Ads, Google Sheets. You have Excel, CSV. So there is also server, Microsoft SQL, MySQL.

You can get connected to YouTube Analytics. There are partner connections also, like for example, Trade Desk, Shopify, Facebook Ads, Microsoft Advertising. So unlike there are so many connectors with which you can connect to your native data and create the dashboard.

The advantage of doing this is you can reset the update frequency. So I am just going to take Google Sheets and I have already copy pasted the EU sample source data into this particular sheet. And I am using the first row as headers.

So you can also do this. You can also include a specific page, include hidden and filtered cells. You can do all that.

And then I'm just going to use the connect button. My data source is getting created. Instead of untitled, I am going to do it EU sample store.

OK, I have done this. So now once you are in this page, there are dimensions which are categorical variables and the record count is only the number here. And it also recognises some of the row ID cells as the number.

OK, so you can do this changes here. For example, state is labelled as text. We know state is a geo variable, so we can make it as a geo variable.

I'm going to say it as country first divisions. OK, this is what we can do. We can make changes like this.

OK, these are all text segment is a text and then default aggregation is some. OK, then we have the customer ID. OK, so customer name is text.

Like that, we have the different categories of the variable which you can add, edit and do all that. Then add a field, add a parameter. OK, data refreshes in 15 minutes.



You can set this to 12 hours. OK, all that you can do that. OK, once you have these things ready, all that you have to do is create report.

So once you click on the create report, OK, this will take to your landing page, which will look like this. So this is now in a landscape format with the data fields and the metric field. So everything is ready.

All that you have to do is now start understanding how to build the data and charts. So the object is to create a dashboard like this. It's not necessarily the exact thing, but having certain things.

I want to understand the sales and I want to understand the geographical location. Why is how the sales are moving? What are the different categories of products that I'm selling? What is the profit per category and what is the composition of the discount rates across different categories like that? So let me just go back here, post and title report and making it executive. Dashboard and what I'm doing, I'm going to do the theme and layout.

Maybe you can use certain preset themes like this. OK, if you have a preset theme, it will make your life easier. So material classic, you can use it.

So you can use a theme or layout, which are already given to you. US letter landscape, I hope to make it portrait. OK, so I just made a portrait and the theme.

It is going to change the theme and you can play around with these things and try to change. OK, currently. So you can do that.

So once we are done with this, let's get started. I'm going to start with writing the heading of this. So here.

Executive sales dashboard. So this is the theme. So I'm just going to make 36.

And I'm going to align it to the centre board. Right. So yeah.

So this is what we do. And also we can add some background to this. OK, maybe a blue background and.

Make it less transparent. Right. So the text colour can be.

The font colour can be made more vibrant. So these are the things we can try to do. So I'm just giving a small example.

This is an executive sales dashboard. I'm going to fill it to the full length here. Yeah.



So this is what I have done. So then I'm going to add a chart. First, I'm starting with a simple table here.

OK, this table set up order ID is not the dimension I'm interested in. I'm interested in region. OK, then I am not interested in.

OK, I have the sales record and the count of what I can do. The number of records will indicate the number of sales. I'm adding the sales metric, adding the profit.

OK, so each region I know what is the. Profit, sales and discount. Also adding the discount rate and look at this discount.

I'm going to change it as average. It is not number number. It is percentage.

And I don't want display format to be percentage zero. So these things are now readily available to me. So this is how the table is looking like.

And you can what you can do, you can adjust these individual rows, individual columns. So that the visibility is very clear. So discount.

So this is what we have done. So you can also go to style, right? 16px for the title. Labels is 12px is 14 now.

And you can extend this so that all the columns are clearly visible. So this is the way you can adjust. So the table is also ready.

And most importantly, you can set the table styling also. So you can do there are a lot of background. I can just put a yellow background, make it 60 or even.

So this is does it look good? No, it doesn't look good. So you can just go back and revert. You just go back and revert.

And this is the table. For now, let us keep it very simple and straightforward. And then you can always try to look and improve the way it is looking up.

OK, so I want a border. We can also have a solid border. So this is the table dashboard and I can what can I do? I can also first and foremost give the chart header.

So we can try to give a title to this. Yeah, show title. So I'm trying to.

Yeah. Teacher. Wise.

Sales. OK, then centre. Bold.



Yeah. So reason why sales I bought this year. Now I can move around the table.

All that I have to do is get onto this symbol and move it around. So I'm just placing it. Yes, I have done this.

And I want it to look bigger. All that I have to do is drag it proportionately and increase the font size. Not the header, the labels.

I want it to look larger. 20 PX. So now the labels are looking bigger.

This also can make it equal quantity. So this is ready now.

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